SPECIAL INTENSIVE REVISION 2025-26

# 13.39 crore names left off the draft rolls across India

The reasons recorded for the names left off in each state, whose names were left off by sex where states published it, and what goes with the rate of exclusion

**13,39,03,307** names left off the draft rolls in 31 states and union territories

**71.5%** of those split by reason entered as shifted, absent or other

**20.9%** entered as dead

**7.6%** entered as enrolled more than once

ImpactMojo · 9 November 2026

# Contents


- In short
- In numbers
- State by state, on one map
- The rolls against the adult population
- The three reasons, by phase
- State by state
- Women among the names left off
- What goes with the rate of exclusion
- After the final rolls
- Against the winning margins
- The roll over forty years
- How the revision was run

**What the Election Commission should do**

**Method and sources**

## In short

1. Before the revision, the rolls already held 98.3% of adults in the 19 states with population projections. Only 6 of those states had more names on the roll than adults.
2. The revision still left 13.39 crore names off the draft rolls, the first published versions of the revised rolls, in 31 states. That is 14.1 of every 100 electors, and the draft rolls now hold 84.5% of adults. States whose rolls were most over-full did not leave off more names.
3. Where the names left off or deleted can be counted seat by seat, in Bihar and Tamil Nadu, they were more than the winning margin, the votes by which the winner beat the runner-up, in 385 of 477 assembly seats. That makes them large enough to have decided those seats, though the lists cannot show that they did. In West Bengal and Kerala only the fall in the roll can be counted, and it was more than the margin in 177 of 434.
4. Of the names left off with a reason given, only 20.9% were entered as dead. The rest are names an officer marked as moved, missing or on the roll twice.
5. The same rules applied in every state. Delhi left off 32.8 of every 100 electors and Lakshadweep 2.5. Among the big states, the share marked moved or not found runs from 49.7% in Andhra Pradesh to 91.1% in Delhi.
6. Women were more likely to be left off. In 10 of the 15 states that report by sex, women are a bigger share of the names left off than of the roll.
7. In the 24 states and union territories with a final roll, the roll published after claims and objections are heard, the final rolls were 1.22 crore larger than the drafts, which is 13.8 for every 100 of the 8.87 crore names left off. That rise is the names added after the draft, new voters among them, less the names deleted after it.

*Two limits. The adult figures count people where they live, so states that draw migrants look short of electors who are registered in their home states. And these figures show what happened. They cannot show why it happened, or that anyone meant it to.*

## In numbers

| 13.39 crore | 71.5% | 20.9% | 14.1 |
|---|---|---|---|
| left off the draft rolls | shifted, absent or other | dead | left off per 100 electors |

The Special Intensive Revision is a fresh check of every name on the electoral rolls, and it has been carried out in three phases. Bihar came first, in 2025, then twelve states and union territories ordered in October 2025, with house visits from November, and eighteen more in 2026. In the 31 that have published a draft roll, 13,39,03,307 electors on the rolls before the revision were not carried onto it. That is 14.1 for every 100. Tripura is to publish its draft on 1 February 2027.

Every state but Dadra and Nagar Haveli and Daman and Diu gave a reason for most of the names it left off. Of the 13.38 crore names split by reason, 2.80 crore (20.9%) were entered as dead, 9.56 crore (71.5%) as shifted, absent or other, and 1.01 crore (7.6%) as enrolled more than once. Deaths are about one in five. The other four in five rest on an officer's entry that the elector was not where the roll placed them, or was on it twice.

A reason is what an officer wrote down after a visit, or after failing to find the elector, and nobody has checked it. The figures cannot say how many entries were wrong.

## State by state, on one map

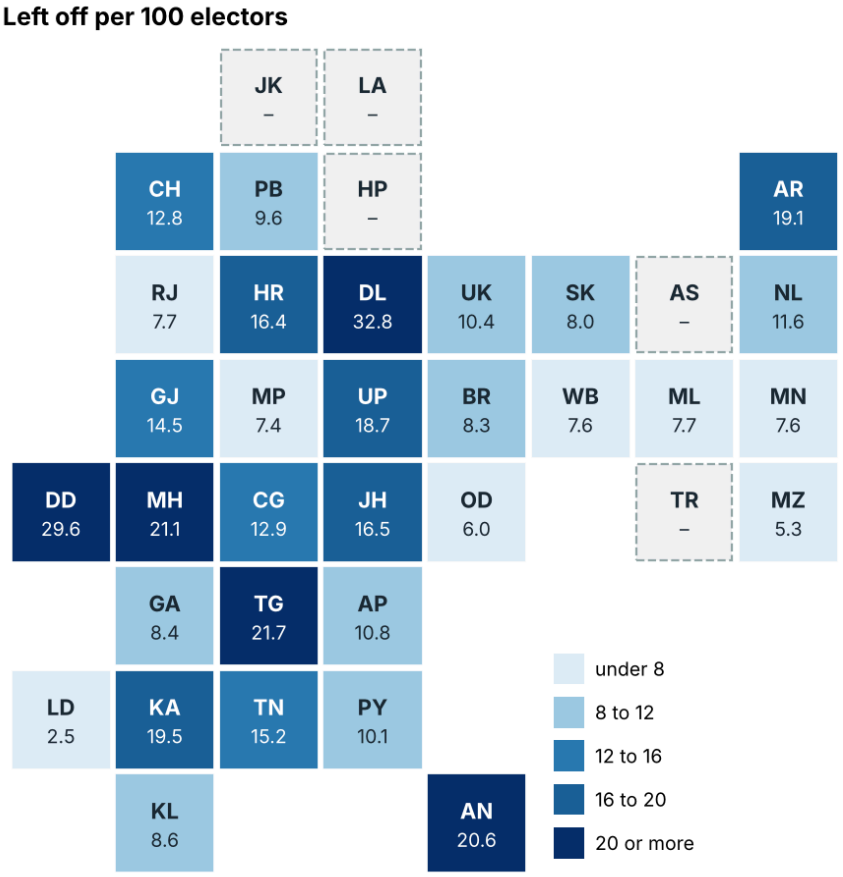



*Figure 1. One tile per state or union territory, placed roughly where it lies, so the tiles show no borders. Grey tiles are states not in the revision (Jammu and Kashmir, Ladakh, Himachal Pradesh, Assam), or with no draft roll yet (Tripura).*

## The rolls against the adult population

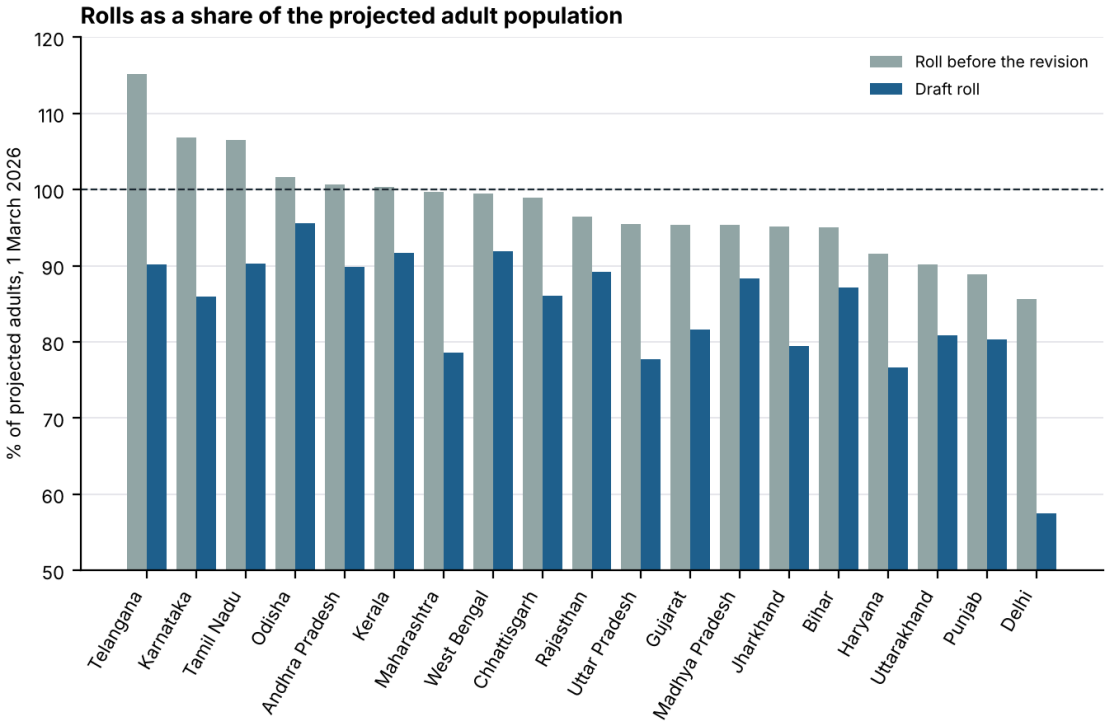



*Figure 2. Nineteen states with projections by age. The dashed line is a roll equal to the adult population.*

A roll larger than the adult population is what a roll swollen by the dead and the departed would look like, and it is the case the revision was meant to answer. Across the 19 states with projections by age, the rolls before the revision held 98.3% of the projected population aged 18 and over, and the draft rolls hold 84.5%. Only 6 had a roll larger than their adult population (Telangana, Karnataka, Tamil Nadu, Odisha, Andhra Pradesh and Kerala). How far a roll exceeded its adult population has no relationship with how many names the state left off (rank correlation 0.05). A rank correlation runs from -1 to 1 and shows whether states that rank high on one measure also rank high on the other. The lowest draft rolls against the adult population are in Delhi (57.5%), Haryana (76.6%) and Uttar Pradesh (77.7%). The projections count residents, so a state that receives many migrants counts adults who may be registered in their home state, which lowers its ratio.

Set against the 2024 Lok Sabha election, the names left off the draft roll equal a fifth or more of the votes polled in 13 states, led by Delhi (53.2%), Dadra and Nagar Haveli and Daman and Diu (42.6%) and Maharashtra (36.1%).

## The three reasons, by phase

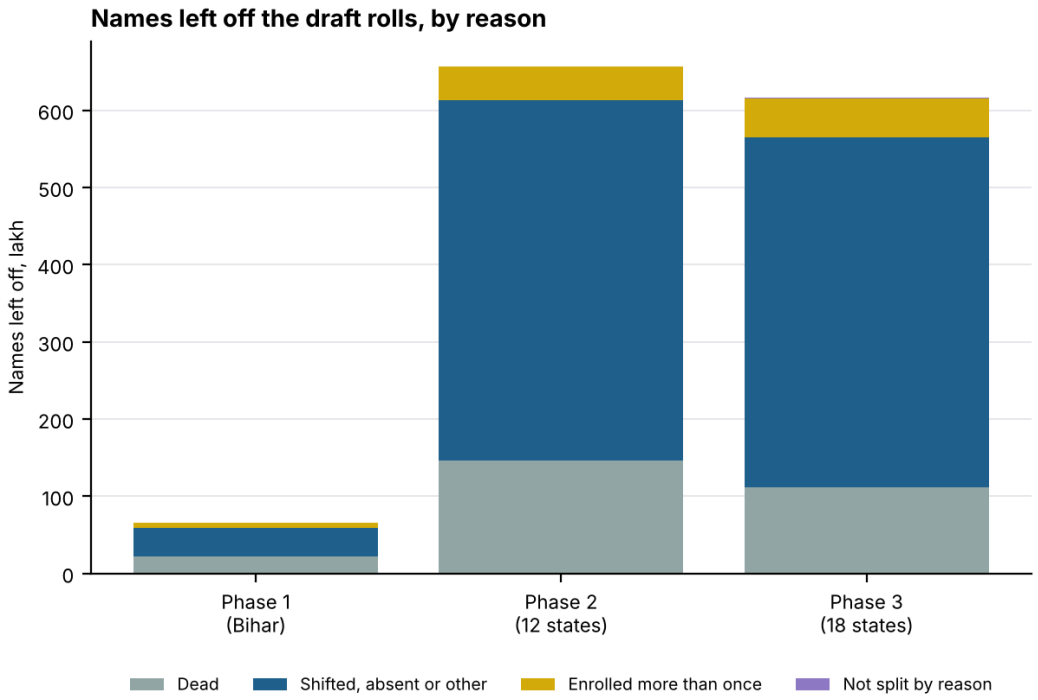



*Figure 3. Names left off the draft rolls in each phase, by the reason entered, in lakh.*

The share entered as dead fell from 34.0% in Bihar to 22.3% in phase 2 and 18.1% in phase 3, while the share entered as shifted, absent or other rose from 55.3% to 71.0% and 73.7%. Names left off per 100 electors rose with each phase, from 8.3 to 12.9 and then 17.0.

## State by state

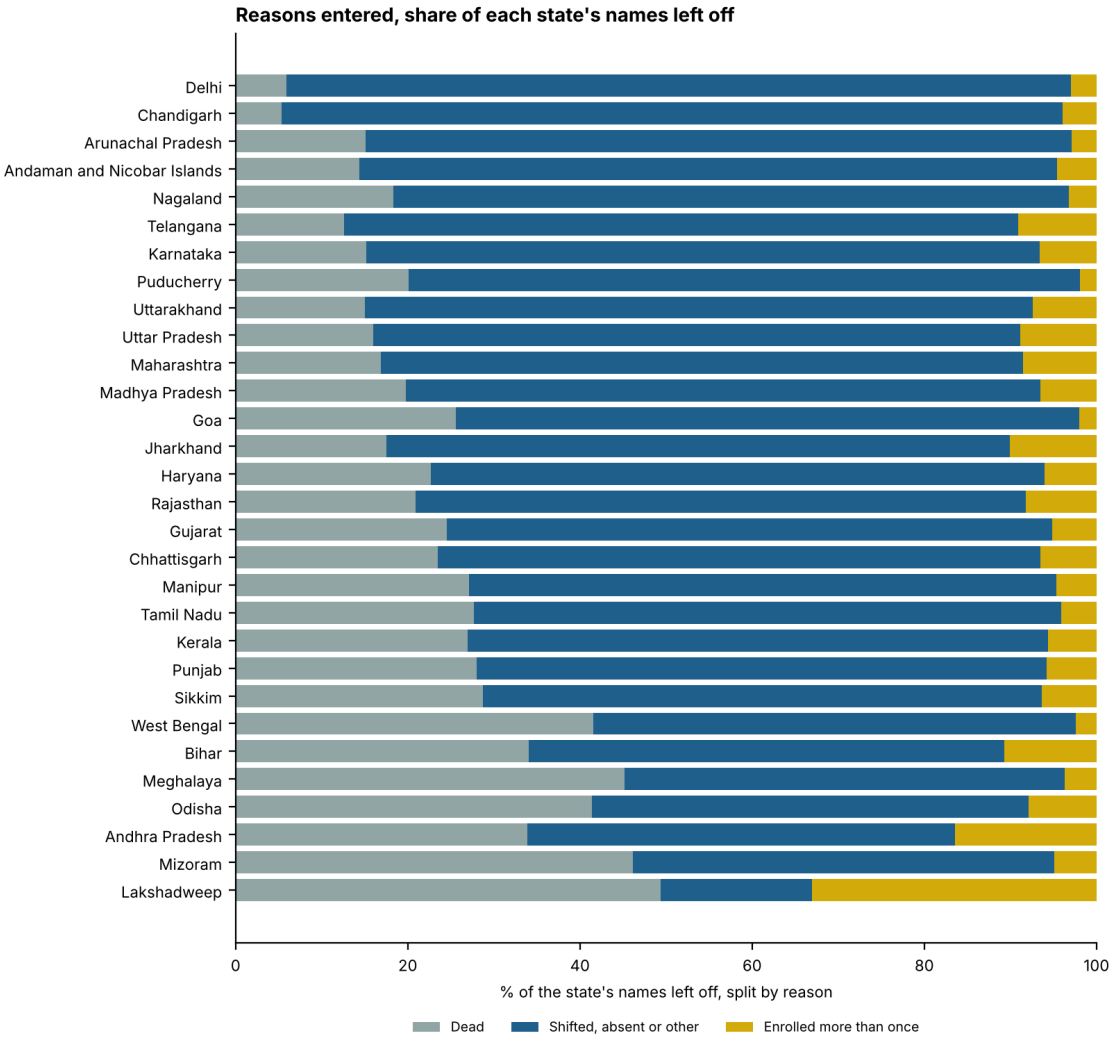



*Figure 4. States that published a split by reason, ordered by the share entered as shifted, absent or other.*

Among states that left off ten lakh names or more, the share entered as shifted, absent or other runs from 49.7% in Andhra Pradesh to 91.1% in Delhi. Among them the share entered as dead is highest in West Bengal (41.5%), and the share entered as enrolled more than once in Andhra Pradesh (16.4%). One revision under one set of instructions produced very different mixes of reasons from state to state, and the Commission has not explained why.

Names left off per 100 electors range from 2.5 in Lakshadweep to 32.8 in Delhi. Uttar Pradesh left off the most names in all, 2.89 crore.

| State or UT | Phase | Left off | Per 100 | Dead | Shifted, absent, other | Duplicate | Split | Figures |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Uttar Pradesh | 2 | 2,88,74,067 | 18.7 | 46,23,796 | 2,17,03,064 | 25,47,207 | Full | exact |
| Maharashtra | 3 | 2,06,88,487 | 21.1 | 34,82,231 | 1,54,39,754 | 17,66,502 | Full | exact |
| Karnataka | 3 | 1,07,96,339 | 19.5 | 16,39,864 | 84,46,605 | 7,09,870 | Full | exact |
| Tamil Nadu | 2 | 97,37,831 | 15.2 | 26,94,672 | 66,44,881 | 3,98,278 | Full | exact |
| Gujarat | 2 | 73,73,327 | 14.5 | 18,07,278 | 51,84,579 | 3,81,470 | Full | exact |
| Telangana | 3 | 73,39,235 | 21.7 | 9,22,229 | 57,46,803 | 6,70,203 | Full | exact |
| Bihar | 1 | 65,59,626 | 8.3 | 22,32,586 | 36,25,981 | 7,01,059 | Full | exact |
| West Bengal | 2 | 58,20,899 | 7.6 | 24,16,852 | 32,65,719 | 1,38,328 | Full | exact |
| Delhi | 3 | 47,56,722 | 32.8 | 2,82,412 | 43,32,775 | 1,41,535 | Full | exact |

| State or UT | Phase | Left off | Per 100 | Dead | Shifted, absent, other | Duplicate | Split | Figures |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Andhra Pradesh | 3 | 44,89,512 | 10.8 | 15,22,000 | 22,30,000 | 7,37,000 | Full | rounded |
| Jharkhand | 3 | 43,61,987 | 16.5 | 7,63,903 | 31,59,488 | 4,38,596 | Full | exact |
| Madhya Pradesh | 2 | 42,74,160 | 7.4 | 8,46,184 | 31,50,997 | 2,76,961 | Full | exact |
| Rajasthan | 2 | 41,84,891 | 7.7 | 8,75,000 | 29,60,000 | 3,44,000 | Full | rounded |
| Haryana | 3 | 33,84,568 | 16.4 | 7,66,205 | 24,13,447 | 2,04,916 | Full | exact |
| Chhattisgarh | 2 | 27,34,817 | 12.9 | 6,42,234 | 19,13,540 | 1,79,043 | Full | exact |
| Kerala | 2 | 24,08,503 | 8.6 | 6,49,885 | 16,22,599 | 1,36,029 | Full | exact |
| Punjab | 3 | 20,66,635 | 9.6 | 5,74,568 | 13,56,846 | 1,19,145 | Short | exact |
| Odisha | 3 | 20,12,557 | 6.0 | 8,32,544 | 10,21,895 | 1,58,118 | Full | exact |
| Uttarakhand | 3 | 8,26,977 | 10.4 | 1,24,173 | 6,41,350 | 61,454 | Full | exact |
| Meghalaya | 3 | 1,80,402 | 7.7 | 81,490 | 92,211 | 6,701 | Full | exact |
| Arunachal Pradesh | 3 | 1,69,459 | 19.1 | 25,573 | 1,38,939 | 4,947 | Full | exact |
| Manipur | 3 | 1,58,677 | 7.6 | 43,000 | 1,08,283 | 7,394 | Full | exact |
| Nagaland | 3 | 1,57,752 | 11.6 | 28,944 | 1,23,749 | 5,059 | Full | exact |
| Dadra and Nagar Haveli and Daman and Diu | 3 | 1,26,894 | 29.6 | – | – | – | None | exact |
| Puducherry | 2 | 1,03,467 | 10.1 | 20,798 | 80,645 | 2,024 | Full | exact |
| Goa | 2 | 1,00,042 | 8.4 | 25,574 | 72,471 | 1,997 | Full | exact |
| Chandigarh | 3 | 66,145 | 12.8 | 3,535 | 60,020 | 2,590 | Full | exact |
| Andaman and Nicobar Islands | 2 | 64,014 | 20.6 | 9,191 | 51,906 | 2,917 | Full | exact |
| Mizoram | 3 | 46,162 | 5.3 | 21,295 | 22,620 | 2,248 | Full | exact |
| Sikkim | 3 | 37,724 | 8.0 | 10,837 | 24,504 | 2,396 | Full | exact |
| Lakshadweep | 2 | 1,429 | 2.5 | 705 | 252 | 472 | Full | exact |
| Tripura | 3 | – | – | – | – | – | No draft | – |

Under Split, Full means the reasons account for the total within rounding, Short means they leave some names unexplained (Punjab), and None means no split was found (Dadra and Nagar Haveli and Daman and Diu). Under Figures, rounded means the state published in lakh or crore (2 states).

## Women among the names left off

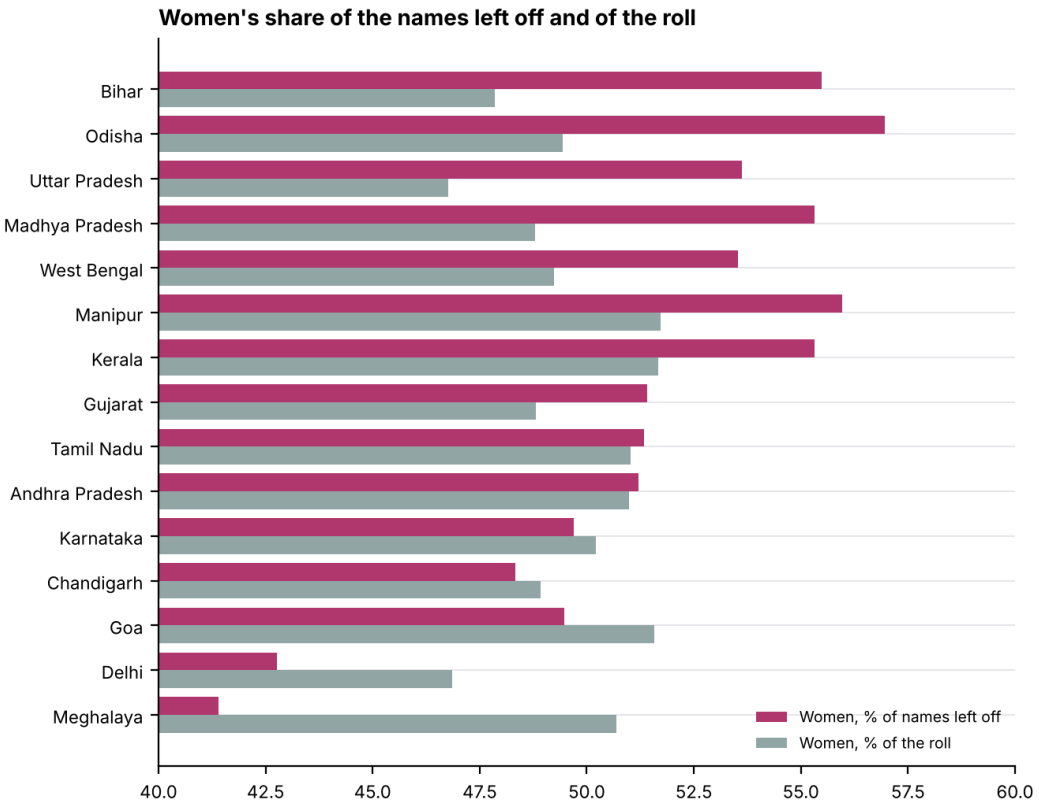



*Figure 5. States that published a split by sex. Bihar's roll before the revision is its draft roll plus the names left off the draft, by sex.*

Only 15 states and union territories have published their names left off by sex, or their roll by sex before the revision and on the draft. In 10 of the 15, women are a larger share of the names left off than of the roll, by up to 7.6 points in Bihar. Tamil Nadu, Andhra Pradesh, Karnataka and Chandigarh are within a point of even. In Goa, Delhi and Meghalaya women are a smaller share of the names left off than of the roll by more than a point, and by 9.3 points in Meghalaya. Most phase 3 states have published no split by sex, so this is not the national picture.

| State | Women left off | Men left off | Women, % left off | Women, % of roll | Difference | Figures |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Bihar | 36,39,976 | 29,19,433 | 55.5 | 47.9 | +7.6 | lists |
| Odisha | 11,46,140 | 8,66,107 | 57.0 | 49.4 | +7.5 | exact |
| Uttar Pradesh | 1,55,00,000 | 1,34,00,000 | 53.6 | 46.8 | +6.9 | rounded |
| Madhya Pradesh | 23,64,531 | 19,09,315 | 55.3 | 48.8 | +6.5 | exact |
| West Bengal | 31,16,050 | 27,04,474 | 53.5 | 49.2 | +4.3 | exact |
| Manipur | 88,799 | 69,871 | 56.0 | 51.7 | +4.2 | exact |
| Kerala | 13,10,361 | 10,58,149 | 55.3 | 51.7 | +3.7 | earlier roll |
| Gujarat | 37,91,000 | 35,82,000 | 51.4 | 48.8 | +2.6 | rounded |
| Tamil Nadu | 49,90,000 | 47,30,000 | 51.3 | 51.0 | +0.3 | unverified |
| Andhra Pradesh | 22,99,035 | 21,89,783 | 51.2 | 51.0 | +0.2 | exact |
| Karnataka | 53,64,049 | 54,30,166 | 49.7 | 50.2 | -0.5 | exact |
| Chandigarh | 31,971 | 34,169 | 48.3 | 48.9 | -0.6 | exact |
| Goa | 49,489 | 50,549 | 49.5 | 51.6 | -2.1 | exact |
| Delhi | 20,34,005 | 27,22,139 | 42.8 | 46.9 | -4.1 | exact |
| Meghalaya | 74,699 | 1,05,701 | 41.4 | 50.7 | -9.3 | exact |

### Third-gender electors

11 states and union territories published the third-gender electors on the roll before the revision and either the number left off the draft or the number on it, so the two can be set side by side. In 6 of the 7 with at least 100 third-gender electors on the roll before the revision, third-gender electors were left off at a higher rate than electors as a whole. In Manipur the rate was lower. The counts are small, a few hundred or a few thousand people in a state, so a few names move the rate a long way. The figures for Delhi, Madhya Pradesh and Odisha came through the press. States are listed alphabetically.

| State | Third-gender electors on the roll before | Left off the draft | Per 100 third-gender electors | All electors left off, per 100 | Roll before, left off |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Andhra Pradesh | 3,430 | 694 | 20.2 | 10.8 | official, official |
| Arunachal Pradesh | 2 | 0 | 0.0 | 19.1 | official, worked out |
| Bihar | 2,043 | 217 | 10.6 | 8.3 | worked out, counted from the lists |
| Delhi | 1,024 | 577 | 56.3 | 32.8 | press, worked out |
| Goa | 13 | 4 | 30.8 | 8.4 | official, worked out |
| Madhya Pradesh | 1,233 | 314 | 25.5 | 7.4 | press, press |
| Manipur | 300 | 7 | 2.3 | 7.6 | official, worked out |
| Meghalaya | 7 | 2 | 28.6 | 7.7 | official, worked out |
| Odisha | 3,085 | 310 | 10.0 | 6.0 | press, press |
| Sikkim | 2 | 0 | 0.0 | 8.0 | official, worked out |
| West Bengal | 1,777 | 375 | 21.1 | 7.6 | official, worked out |

## What goes with the rate of exclusion

Each state's names left off per 100 electors, and the shares of those names entered as dead or as enrolled more than once, are set against its characteristics as rank correlations across states. A value of 1 means the two rise together, 0 means no relationship, and anything under 0.2 either way is read as none. The number of states in each is in brackets.

| Characteristic | Rate, all states | Rate, phase 2 | Rate, phase 3 | Share dead | Share twice, larger states |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Share of residents born in another state (Census 2011) | 0.51 (29) | 0.04 (12) | 0.62 (16) | -0.53 (28) | -0.24 (17) |
| Income per head (RBI, 2023-24) | 0.38 (29) | 0.17 (11) | 0.47 (17) | -0.31 (29) | -0.39 (19) |
| Urban spending per head (HCES 2023-24) | 0.26 (31) | 0.28 (12) | 0.15 (18) | -0.32 (30) | -0.32 (19) |
| SC share of households (NFHS-5, 2019-21 (households)) | 0.19 (31) | 0.01 (12) | 0.37 (18) | -0.15 (30) | -0.13 (19) |
| Muslim share of households (NFHS-5, 2019-21 (households)) | 0.09 (31) | -0.27 (12) | 0.46 (18) | -0.13 (30) | 0.00 (19) |
| Urban share (Technical Group projection, 2026) | 0.09 (30) | -0.24 (12) | 0.30 (17) | -0.10 (30) | -0.57 (19) |
| Rural spending per head (HCES 2023-24) | 0.07 (31) | 0.09 (12) | 0.06 (18) | -0.15 (30) | -0.33 (19) |
| Share born here but living in another state (Census 2011) | 0.03 (29) | -0.30 (12) | 0.29 (16) | -0.22 (28) | 0.26 (17) |
| Literacy (PLFS 2023-24) | -0.11 (31) | -0.04 (12) | -0.20 (18) | 0.11 (30) | -0.66 (19) |
| Women's literacy (PLFS 2023-24) | -0.14 (31) | -0.10 (12) | -0.20 (18) | 0.15 (30) | -0.70 (19) |
| ST share of households (NFHS-5, 2019-21 (households)) | -0.26 (31) | -0.45 (12) | -0.26 (18) | 0.32 (30) | 0.28 (19) |
| Sex ratio (NFHS-5, 2019-21) | -0.46 (31) | -0.36 (12) | -0.46 (18) | 0.49 (30) | 0.29 (19) |

Across all states the rate of exclusion goes most with the share of residents born in another state (0.51), and that comes from phase 3 (0.62). In phase 2 it is 0.04. In phase 3, income per head, Muslim share of households, sex ratio and share of residents born in another state all go with the rate of exclusion, because the big states that draw migrants were revised in the same phase as the North-East, and they differ from it on all of these at once. With only 16 to 18 states in the phase, there is no telling these apart. The only characteristics that go with the rate of exclusion the same way in both phases are ST share of households (-0.45 in phase 2, -0.26 in phase 3) and sex ratio (-0.36 in phase 2, -0.46 in phase 3). The Muslim share of households has no consistent relationship, 0.09 across all states, -0.27 in phase 2 and 0.46 in phase 3. Among the larger states, the share entered as enrolled more than once goes most with women's literacy (-0.70). Migration is from the 2011 census because no newer figure is published by state, and every other characteristic is from 2019 to 2026. Run on the 2011 census values instead, the reading changes only for urban share.

States on an international border left fewer names off than interior states. The typical border state left off 8.3 per 100 electors across 13 states, and the typical interior state 14.0 across 18. None of these relationships says whose names were left off inside a state, because a pattern across states says nothing about individuals.

## After the final rolls

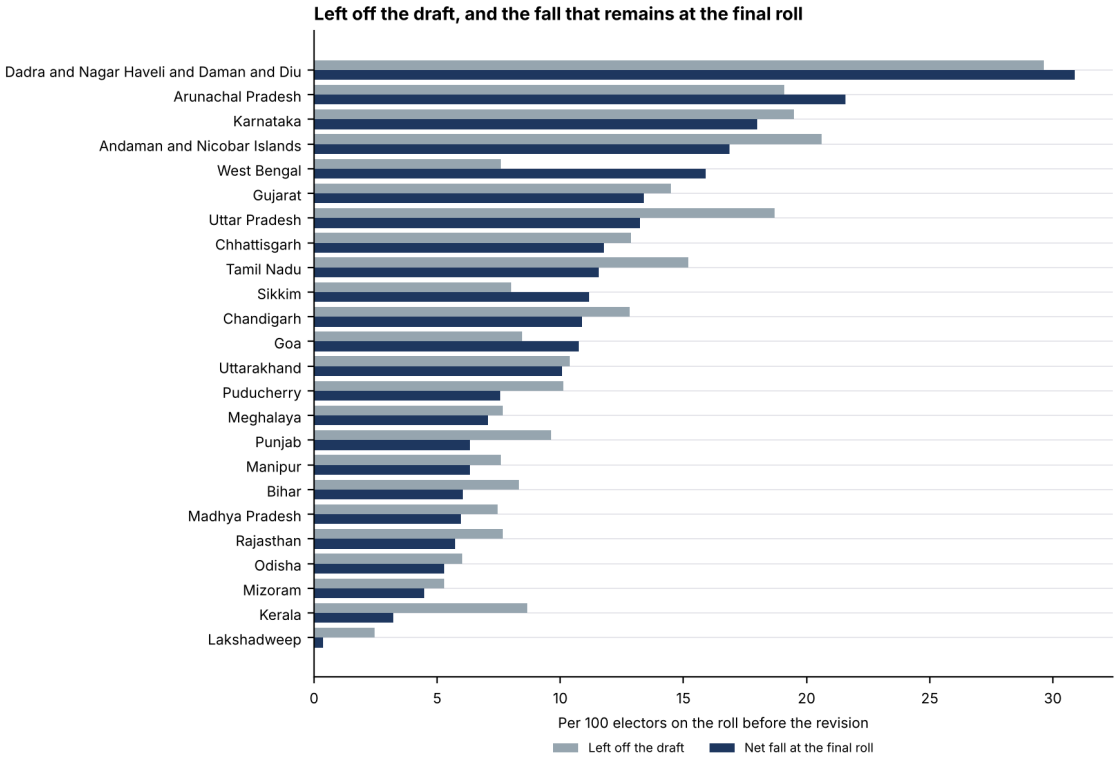



*Figure 6. States whose final roll is out and whose roll before the revision was published exactly enough to set against it.*

In the 24 states and union territories with a final roll, 8.87 crore names were left off the drafts, and the final rolls came out 1.22 crore larger than the drafts, which is 13.8% of the fall. West Bengal kept 60.1 lakh names off its final roll for adjudication. As reported, 32.7 lakh were later found eligible and 27.2 lakh not, and appeals continue. Without them the final rolls were 1.82 crore larger, 20.5% of the fall. The net fall is the roll before the revision less the final roll. It comes to 10.7 per 100 electors, against 12.4 left off at the draft.

The rise from draft to final is the names added after the draft, new voters among them, less the names deleted after it, and no state has said how many of those added had been left off the draft. The final roll is smaller than the draft in 5 states (West Bengal, Goa, Arunachal Pradesh, Dadra and Nagar Haveli and Daman and Diu and

Sikkim). How many names a state left off the draft has no relationship with how much of that its final roll made up (rank correlation -0.18).

| State or UT | Left off the draft | Added after | Deleted after | Final less draft | As % of left off | Net fall per 100 | Figures |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Uttar Pradesh | 2,88,74,067 | – | 8,15,996 | 84,28,767 | 29.2% | 13.2 | Net only |
| Karnataka | 1,07,96,339 | 10,08,000 | 1,88,000 | 8,19,714 | 7.6% | 18.0 | Rounded |
| Tamil Nadu | 97,37,831 | 27,53,796 | 4,23,172 | 23,30,624 | 23.9% | 11.6 | Adds up |
| Gujarat | 73,73,327 | 9,56,121 | 3,95,555 | 5,60,616 | 7.6% | 13.4 | Does not add up |
| Bihar | 65,59,626 | 21,53,343 | 3,66,742 | 17,86,601 | 27.2% | 6.0 | Adds up |
| West Bengal | 58,20,899 | 1,88,707 | 5,46,053 | −63,64,021 | −109.3% | 15.9 | Adds up |
| Madhya Pradesh | 42,74,160 | – | – | 8,49,082 | 19.9% | 6.0 | Net only |
| Rajasthan | 41,84,891 | 12,91,365 | 2,42,760 | 10,48,605 | 25.1% | 5.7 | Adds up |
| Chhattisgarh | 27,34,817 | 3,43,801 | 1,08,807 | 2,34,994 | 8.6% | 11.8 | Adds up |
| Kerala | 24,08,503 | 15,11,292 | 53,229 | 15,11,292 | 62.7% | 3.2 | Does not add up |
| Punjab | 20,66,635 | 7,97,263 | 86,038 | 7,06,292 | 34.2% | 6.3 | Does not add up |
| Odisha | 20,12,557 | 2,90,497 | 44,777 | 2,45,720 | 12.2% | 5.3 | Adds up |
| Uttarakhand | 8,26,977 | 1,29,872 | 1,04,708 | 25,164 | 3.0% | 10.1 | Adds up |
| Meghalaya | 1,80,402 | 23,970 | 9,250 | 14,720 | 8.2% | 7.1 | Adds up * |
| Arunachal Pradesh | 1,69,459 | 8,803 | 30,823 | −22,020 | −13.0% | 21.6 | Adds up |
| Manipur | 1,58,677 | 56,871 | 30,650 | 26,221 | 16.5% | 6.3 | Adds up |
| Dadra and Nagar Haveli and Daman and Diu | 1,26,894 | – | – | −5,309 | −4.2% | 30.9 | Net only |
| Puducherry | 1,03,467 | 42,719 | 16,619 | 26,100 | 25.2% | 7.6 | Adds up |
| Goa | 1,00,042 | 12,166 | 39,592 | −27,426 | −27.4% | 10.8 | Adds up |
| Chandigarh | 66,145 | 15,117 | 5,190 | 9,927 | 15.0% | 10.9 | Adds up |
| Andaman and Nicobar Islands | 64,014 | 16,919 | 5,269 | 11,650 | 18.2% | 16.9 | Adds up |
| Mizoram | 46,162 | 39,243 | 32,280 | 6,963 | 15.1% | 4.5 | Adds up |
| Sikkim | 37,724 | 1,982 | 16,809 | −14,827 | −39.3% | 11.2 | Adds up |
| Lakshadweep | 1,429 | 1,270 | 47 | 1,223 | 85.6% | 0.4 | Adds up |

Under Figures, adds up means the draft plus additions less deletions equals the final roll, net only means the state published the draft and final rolls but not the additions and deletions behind the difference, and does not add up means the published figures do not match (Gujarat, Kerala and Punjab). Deletions after the draft carry no reason in any state except Bihar, so they are outside every figure by reason in this report. Maharashtra, Telangana, Delhi, Andhra Pradesh, Jharkhand, Haryana and Nagaland have not yet published a final roll.

* For Meghalaya the press note gives the forms accepted after the draft without grouping them into additions and deletions. The grouping in the table is an inference from the arithmetic, and it is the grouping under which the figures add up.

## Against the winning margins

A seat is decided by the votes between its winner and its runner-up. Where more names left a seat's roll than that margin, the names left off or deleted were enough to decide the seat. Whether they did depends on how those people would have voted, and that can be estimated only where the lists say who they were.

| State | Election | Seats | Count larger than the margin | What is counted |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| Bihar | 2025 | 243 | 174 (71.6%) | names left off or deleted, both phases |
| Tamil Nadu | 2026 | 234 | 211 (90.2%) | names left off the draft |
| West Bengal | 2026 | 294 | 139 (47.3%) | fall in the roll from 2024 to the 2026 election |
| Kerala | 2026 | 140 | 38 (27.1%) | fall in the roll from January 2025 to the 2026 election |

In Bihar and Tamil Nadu, where the names left off or deleted are counted seat by seat, they were more than the winning margin in 385 of 477 assembly seats. West Bengal and Kerala publish no count of names left off by seat, so their count is the fall in the roll, which also takes in ordinary deaths and moves, and it was more than the margin in 177 of 434. The two are kept apart because they count different things.

Bihar is the one state whose lists show whose names were left off or deleted. Estimating how they would have voted from their own booths in 2024, 4 to 6 seats would have changed hands, in both directions, and on every estimate the NDA keeps a majority, with 200 to 204 of 243 seats.

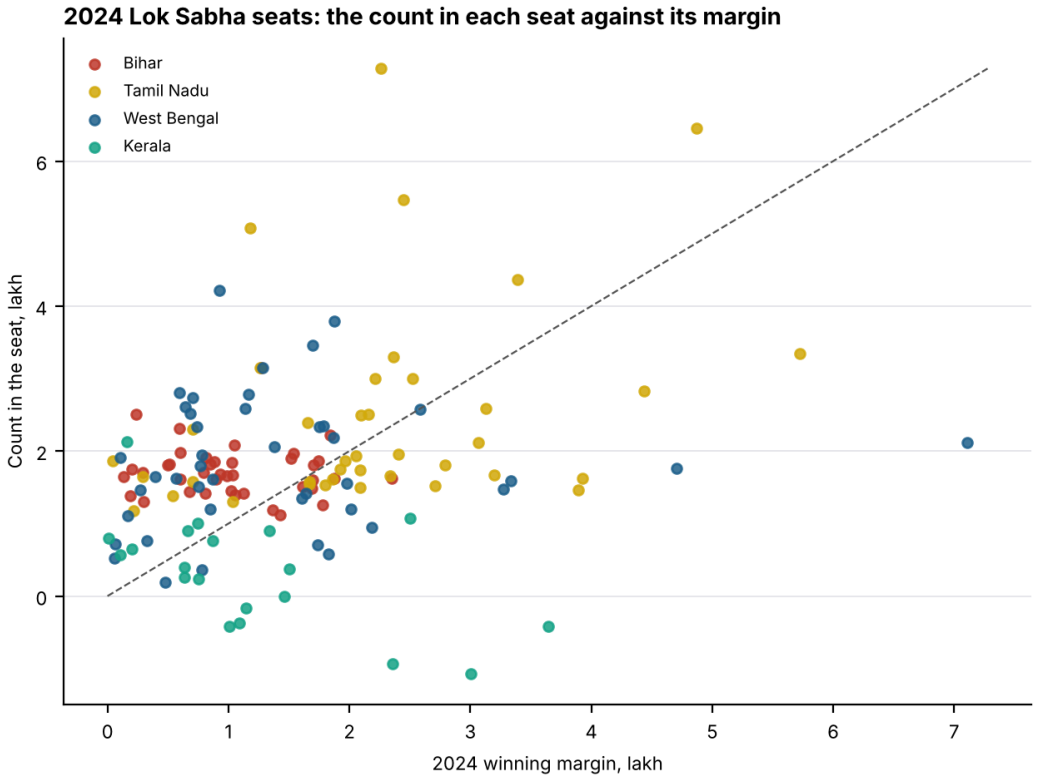



*Figure 7. Each dot is a 2024 Lok Sabha seat in the four states, its count added up from its assembly segments. Above the dashed line, the count is larger than the margin. Below zero are Kerala seats whose roll grew.*

Set against the 2024 Lok Sabha results, the count in each seat was larger than the margin in 51 of 79 seats in Bihar and Tamil Nadu and 34 of 62 in West Bengal and Kerala. The revision came after the 2024 election, so this measures how large the exclusions are against the votes that decide a seat, and it does not say what happened in 2024.

No state has published its names left off by Lok Sabha seat. Spread evenly over each state's seats, the names left off would be larger than the 2024 margin in 373 of 516 seats in 31 states and union territories. Where seat counts exist the even spread can be tested. In Bihar it gives 32 seats against 32 counted, and in Tamil Nadu 27 against 19, because the names left off there were heaviest in the cities and most seats lost fewer names than the state average. It is a rough guide that can run high. In 2024, 115 of 542 contested seats were won by fewer than 50,000 votes.

## The roll over forty years

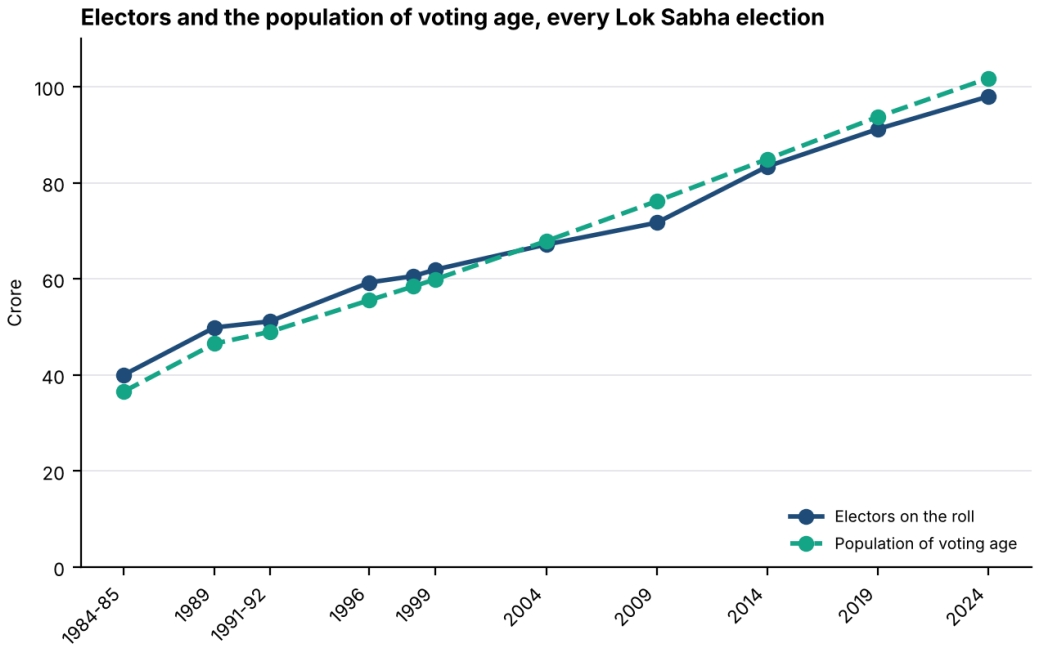



*Figure 8. Electors from the Election Commission's Atlas 2024 (Graph 6.1). Population of voting age, 21 and over in 1984-85 and 18 and over from 1989, from the UN World Population Prospects 2024, a modelled estimate that counts everyone living in India, citizens or not.*

The roll grew from 40.04 crore in 1984-85 to 97.98 crore in 2024. In every election to 1999 it held more names than there were people of voting age, up to 109.5 for every 100 in 1984-85. If the population estimate is right, a roll that large carried the names of people who had died or moved, or counted some people twice. From 2004 it has held fewer, 96 for every 100 in 2024. Some of that gap is people who are not citizens, whom the population counts and the roll cannot.

In the ten years from 2014 to 2024 the roll gained 14.57 crore. The 13.39 crore names left off the draft rolls are 92 in every 100 of that gain, though the two are not strictly alike, because the revision covered 31 states and union territories and the Lok Sabha figure is all India.

## How the revision was run

The rules changed while the revision was under way. It was governed by 42 orders, letters and judgments, 12 of them from the Supreme Court. Across 32 states and union territories, dates were changed 38 times in the published orders and notes.

What made it harder to stay on the roll, each point resting on an order or a judgment:

1. A fresh form from every elector. Only electors whose enumeration forms came back were put on the draft roll. The enumeration form was a fresh form each elector on the roll had to fill in and return. The draft roll was the roll published from those forms, open to claims to add names and objections to names on it before the final roll. A name on the roll for years was left off the draft if its form did not come back in time, and its owner then had to ask to be put back.
2. Parents' documents, by year of birth. In Bihar the younger the elector, the more documents were needed. Anyone born after 2 December 2004 needed documents for themselves and for both parents, and a parent's passport and visa if a parent was not Indian.
3. Aadhaar only on the Court's order. Aadhaar was not on the first list of eleven documents. Claims could carry it from mid-August 2025, as the Commission agreed before the Supreme Court. It became the twelfth document on the Court's order of 8 September 2025, as proof of identity.

4. The declaration changed twice. Form 6, the application to be added to the roll, carried a new declaration from June 2025, a different one from October 2025, and a shorter list of documents from May 2026. No Gazette notification could be found amending the forms of the Registration of Electors Rules, 1960 to match.
5. Dates moved after they were set. All 12 Phase II states and union territories had their dates moved by a week, and 7 were moved again. In Phase III, the published orders and notes show dates moved in 11 of 19. An elector working to one deadline could find it had changed.
6. Anyone could object to anyone. Form 7 is the form for objecting to a name on the roll. A person who was not an elector of the constituency could object to a name on oath, a party agent could file ten forms a day after the draft, and Form 7 sets no limit on how many one person may file. In Bihar, objections to names on the roll outnumbered claims to be included by about six to one at the deadline.
7. Notices for logical discrepancies. People flagged for logical discrepancies, where something in their link to the old roll did not match, were called to hearings. The Supreme Court had to order that a representative could file for them and that they get ten more days. Only from September 2026 would booth officers collect their documents at home.
8. Sixty lakh held back in West Bengal. West Bengal's final roll left out 60,06,675 names marked under adjudication. They waited on judicial officers and then on nineteen tribunals, and a pending appeal gave no right to vote.
9. Names added after the draft. All 21 states that published both counts added fewer names after the draft, new electors included, than they left off it, and 4 added fewer than 10 for every 100 left off.

*The press reported 38 further problems in the field. No document confirms them, so they are not among the points above.*

## What the Election Commission should do

13.39 crore names were left off the draft rolls, about four in five of them on an entry that the elector had moved, could not be found, or was on the roll twice. The Election Commission should:

1. Publish a state-by-state table of its own, in exact figures, with the reason for every name left off the draft and every name deleted after it.
2. Publish the lists of names left off and deleted, with the reason against each name, for every state, as it did for Bihar, so that they can be counted by booth, sex and age.
3. Publish the basis for entries marked absent and enrolled more than once.
4. Publish the outcome of every claim and objection, and say how many of those added at the final roll had been left off the draft, so that restorations can be set against exclusions.
5. Explain why the mix of reasons differs so widely between states under one set of instructions.

## Method and sources

Each state's Chief Electoral Officer, the Election Commission's officer in charge of its rolls, published figures when the draft roll came out, and the All India figures are those officers' own. They are taken from the press notes of (Uttar Pradesh, Tamil Nadu, West Bengal, Rajasthan, Lakshadweep, Maharashtra, Karnataka, Telangana, Delhi, Andhra Pradesh, Uttarakhand, Meghalaya, Arunachal Pradesh, Manipur, Nagaland, Mizoram and Sikkim) and from press reports for the other states. Bihar's row is counted from the lists of names left off the draft. The reasons are grouped into the three every state reported. The state rows add up to 13.39 crore left off, against the about 13.3 crore reported nationally on 30 September 2026, and the difference is rounding. Each row's source is listed on the method page and in the downloadable table.

No name, EPIC number or address is published.